

Include a caveat under chapter 1 explaining that the data is self-reported and can lead to an underrepresentation of the actual substance usage. make these letters red.

On it! Adding a red caveat box under the Chapter 1 bar chart now. Here is exactly what it will say:

"△ These numbers may be higher than reported. Because the NSDUH relies on self reported responses, individuals may underreport substance use due to stigma, fear of legal consequences, or social pressure. Research from NIDA and the CDC consistently suggests actual use rates are higher than what surveys capture. The TEDS dataset, which tracks real treatment admissions, recorded over 4.2 million treatment episodes across 2021 to 2023 alone — supporting the idea that the true scale of this crisis exceeds what self reported data can capture."

The text will appear in red underneath the bar chart on Chapter 1 only. Nothing else in the

Is there a reason for having very little data on fentanyl, cocaine, and heroine?

Yes — there are two reasons for this.

The first is that these substances genuinely have lower self reported use rates in the general population. Fentanyl, cocaine, and heroin are all under 1% for past 30 day use in the NSDUH survey. Alcohol and marijuana are used by a much larger portion of the general public so the numbers naturally look much bigger in comparison.

The second reason is self reporting bias. Because fentanyl, cocaine, and heroin carry serious legal consequences and heavy social stigma, people are significantly less likely to admit to using them on a government survey compared to alcohol or marijuana. The actual use rates for these substances are almost certainly higher than what the data shows.

This is actually why the self reporting caveat on Chapter 1 is so important. The red callout box flags that all numbers in the NSDUH are likely underestimates — but that underestimation is especially significant for substances like fentanyl, cocaine, and heroin where the consequences of admitting use are the most severe.